Bisaya for Thomas

Course guide: what this course is for, how it was designed, and how to use it every day

Maayong pag-abot! (Welcome!)

This is a 13-week, 30-minutes-a-day course in Bisaya (Cebuano), built for one purpose: so you can talk with Jiana's family in Bohol - at the dinner table, in the living room, on the way to church, and on video calls. It is not a general language course. Every sentence in it is something Nanay, Tatay, Kuya, Dodong, Inday or Jiana is likely to say to you, or something you will want to say to them.

Your goals for the 90 days

Goal	What it looks like in Bohol
1. Understand what the family says to you	You recognize Kaon na! (Come eat!), Kapoy ka? (Are you tired?) and Kanus-a ka mouli? (When are you going home?) when you hear them at natural speed.
2. Answer with short, ready-made phrases	You can answer without translating in your head: Busog na ko. (I'm full.) Lami kaayo! (Very delicious!) Mobalik gyud ko. (I'll definitely come back.)
3. Keep the conversation going when you're lost	Instead of smiling and nodding, you say Unsa? (What?), Hinay-hinay lang, palihug. (Slowly, please.) or Wala ko kasabot. (I don't understand.)

Goal 3 matters most. With the phrases from Week 1, no conversation can leave you completely stuck - and families warm up quickly to someone who keeps trying.

What this course focuses on

Phrases, not word lists

You never memorize a single word on its own. You learn whole phrases ("chunks") exactly as people say them - Kaon pa! instead of 'kaon = eat, pa = more'. Short tips explain the parts, but the chunk is what you keep.

Real people, real situations

Every line belongs to someone in Jiana's family and to a real scene: arriving at the house, the dinner table, a fiesta, a motorbike ride, a video call. You learn what you will actually hear.

Listening first

Most exercises start with audio. Understanding comes before speaking, so you hear each phrase many times before you have to produce it.

Bisaya mixed with English

Families in Bohol switch between Bisaya and English all the time: Okay ra, Jet lag pa ka?, Asa ang CR? The course teaches this natural mix instead of an artificial 'pure' language.

Very little grammar

There are no grammar lessons. A few small patterns (nag- = doing now, mo- = will, ka = you, ko = I) are pointed out inside the tips, only when they help.

Speaking out loud every day

After every exercise you repeat the phrase three times out loud, and each lesson ends with five minutes of reading aloud. Your mouth needs practice, not only your ears.

Culture with every lesson

Each day has a short culture note: the mano blessing, why hosts keep saying Kaon pa!, fiestas, pasalubong, Filipino time. Knowing these matters as much as the words.

Practice with Jiana

Each week ends with a video-call mission, so what you learn is used with a real person within days.

The 13 weeks

Each week has about 22-25 new phrases, spread over six days, plus a seventh day of conversations and a mission. The weeks build on each other, and earlier phrases keep coming back in reviews and conversations.

Week	Theme	Examples you will learn
1	Greetings, introductions, asking to repeat	Maayong buntag! - Mano, Nay. - Wala ko kasabot. - Unsa'y English ana?
2	At the dinner table	Kaon na! - Busog na ko. - Lami kaayo! - Nikaon na ka?
3	The family and what they ask you	Kini si Kuya. - Pila imong igsoon? - Ako ang uyab ni Jiana.
4	Health, heat, feeling tired	Kapoy ka? - Init kaayo! - Sakit akong ulo. - Katulgon na ko.
5	Numbers, time, arriving and leaving	Kanus-a ka niabot? - Alas tres na. - Usa, duha, tulo...
6	Likes, dislikes, food reactions	Ganahan ka og isda? - Halang! - Paborito nako ang lechon.
7	Shopping, the market, prices	Pila ni? - Mahal kaayo! - Pwede hangyo? - Asa ang CR?
8	Church, fiesta, family events	Mosimba ta. - Mosayaw ka? - Kanta ta! - Salamat sa pag-imbita.
9	Daily life at home	Maligo na ka. - Unsa'y akong matabang? - Brownout na pud!
10	Going out around Bohol	Asa ta padulong? - Liko sa wala. - Nindot kaayo ang dagat!
11	Video calls with Jiana	Madungog ko nimo? - Mingaw na ko nimo. - Gihigugma tika.
12	Thanks, feelings, goodbye	Salamat sa tanan. - Mingawon ko ninyo. - Mobalik gyud ko.
13	Full review: the whole trip	From Jiana! Mingaw kaayo ko nimo! at the airport to Mobalik gyud ko. Babay! at the door.

Who you will hear

Person	Who they are	Voice
Thomas	You. Your own lines are the ones to practice saying.	Male voice
Jiana	Your girlfriend - often on video calls.	Female voice
Nanay / Tatay	Jiana's mother and father (Nay, Tay for short).	Female / male
Kuya / Dodong / Inday	Jiana's older brother, younger brother, and younger sister.	Male / male / female
Tindera	A market vendor (Week 7 only).	Female voice

The audio was generated with natural-sounding Cebuano AI voices, recorded once at natural speed. Use the Slow button whenever you need it.

How to use the course

Opening it

- Open the course page in Claude: https://claude.ai/artifact/U49bQF6puCEADHm5BrGmiY (it must be shared with you from the Share menu first).
- It works on a phone, tablet or computer. A phone with headphones is ideal.
- Your progress and review schedule are saved in the browser you use. Use the same device and browser every day so your progress follows you.

Your daily 30 minutes

Part	Time	What you do
New lesson	about 15 min	Read the culture note. Meet each new phrase: listen, use Slow if needed, read the tip, say it once. Then answer the practice questions.
Review	about 10 min	Phrases from earlier days that are due come back automatically - the ones you missed and the ones you just learned.
Read aloud	about 5 min	Go down the list of today's phrases (or the week's conversations) and say each one out loud three times.

Press **Start today's lesson** on the home screen - the course always knows which day is next. When you finish, the day is marked done and the next one opens.

The practice questions (from easiest to hardest)

Type	What you do
What does this mean?	Listen to a phrase and choose its English meaning.
Where would you hear this?	Listen and choose the scene: dinner table, airport, church, market...
What do you say back?	A family member speaks (or a situation is described). Choose your reply. This is a mini conversation.
Fill in the blank	Choose the missing word in a phrase. The English meaning is shown as a hint.
Put the pieces in order	Tap phrase pieces in the right order. Sometimes one piece doesn't belong. If Bisaya allows more than one order, every correct order is accepted.
Listen and repeat 3 times	After every question: play the phrase and say it out loud three times, tapping a circle each time.

If you answer wrong, the correct answer and its audio are shown, and the question comes back once at the end of the lesson.

Day 7 and the video-call mission

The seventh day of each week has no new phrases. You listen to three short conversations (you can hide the English the second time), answer as Thomas, and then get the week's mission: five or six things to try on your next video call with Jiana. Tick each step when you've done it. Jiana is your best teacher - ask her to correct your pronunciation and to teach you how her family says things.

How the review works

Every question you meet goes into a review box. A new or missed question comes back the next day. Each time you get it right, it waits longer before it returns: 3 days, then 7, 14 and 30 days. This spacing is what moves phrases into long-term memory. The **Review** card on the home screen shows how many are due; you can also run a review on its own on days without a new lesson.

Tips for getting the most out of it

- **Say everything out loud.** Whispering or thinking it doesn't train your mouth. The three-repetition screens are the most valuable part of the course - don't skip them.
- **Copy the music, not just the words.** Bisaya has a rhythm and melody. Imitate the speaker's tone, speed and stress.
- **Use Slow, then normal.** Listen slowly to catch the sounds, then switch back to normal speed - that's how the family will talk.
- **A little every day beats a lot once a week.** If you only have 10 minutes, do the review. If you miss a day, simply continue - the course waits for you.
- **Don't worry about grammar.** If a phrase works, use it as it is. Understanding why comes later, on its own.
- **Expect a different accent.** In Bohol you may hear 'maajo' for 'maayo' and slightly different words from family to family. Ask Jiana, and use the family's version.
- **Use your survival phrases without shame.** Unsa? and Hinay-hinay lang, palihug are signs of effort, not failure. Filipino families appreciate the effort enormously.
- **Before a trip,** repeat Week 13 and the weeks for situations you expect (Week 2 for meals, Week 8 if there's a fiesta).

Your survival kit (Week 1)

Bisaya	English	When to use it
Unsa?	What?	You didn't catch something.
Hinay-hinay lang, palihug.	Slowly, please.	Someone is speaking too fast.
Balika, palihug.	Say it again, please.	You almost caught it.
Wala ko kasabot.	I don't understand.	You heard it but don't know the meaning.
Unsa'y English ana?	What's that in English?	You need the meaning of a word.
Salamat kaayo.	Thank you very much.	Always.

Good to know

- The Bisaya in this course is standard Cebuano with natural English mixing. It has not yet been fully checked by a native speaker; a review sheet is kept so that Jiana or her family can correct anything that sounds unnatural.
- The voices are AI-generated. They are clear and natural, but real people in Bohol will speak faster, with local accent and slang - that's what the survival phrases are for.
- Resetting progress (link at the bottom of the home screen) erases everything on that device, so use it only to start over.

> **Kaya nimo ni! - You can do this!**
>
> Thirty minutes a day for thirteen weeks is about 45 hours of practice - enough to change how your next visit feels. Maayong pagtuon! (Happy studying!)